

Michael Torbensen

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Dependable UCSB Environmental Science student with extensive knowledge of coastal ecology, geology, and strong experience working with the public. Skilled at communicating scientific concepts in simple and engaging ways to create positive learning experiences for all. Adaptable, patient, and passionate about providing ethical environmental work.

Education

UC Santa Barbara | B.S. Environmental Science | Expected June 2027

- Completed lower-division STEM courses with emphasis in Biology and Ecology
- Gained field and lab experience in coastal ecosystems and species identification

Santa Barbara City College (SBCC) | May 2024

- Environmental Geology & Geologic Field Courses (Colorado Plateau & Sierra Nevadas)
- Honor Roll Spring 2021 (3.75 GPA)
- Environmental Science (AS) degree

Work Experience

Sprouts — *Sole Baker*

Goleta, CA | May 2023 - May 2024

- Effectively communicated with employees in different departments to ensure corporate standards were being met
- Encouraged other workers to follow recycling/trash protocols and mitigated issues with manager(s)
- Collaborated with the department manager to expand knowledge on and complete managerial duties

Interra Designs — *B2B Sales Representative*

Laguna Beach, CA | Oct. 2019 - Jan. 2023

- Created and cultivated quality long-term relationships with over 800 clients by addressing needs and providing superior customer service
- Collaborated with the owner to provide professional customer feedback and recommend changes to meet emerging trends
- Effectively communicated with a broad range of professionals to promote products and services

REI — Retail Sales Associate

Santa Barbara, CA | Nov. 2021 - May 2022

- Assisted customers in a friendly and communicative way
- Upheld REI social standards by sharing knowledge about the wilderness and outdoor equipment
- Gained exceptional product knowledge and experience collaborating with co-workers

Expertise

- Usage of spatial analysis tools like ArcGIS Pro
- Delineating watersheds and calculating flow direction using Digital Elevation Models (DEM's)
- Ability to estimate flood risks, streamflow, and runoff
- Data automation using R Studio to clean data sets and run spatial statistics
- Understanding local, state, and federal environmental legislation
- Interpersonal and external communication skills
- Science communication
- California coastal ecosystems

Coursework

- Ecosystem Services and Biodiversity
- Form, Processes, and Human Use of Rivers
- Applied Watershed Management
- Conservation Planning
- Biodiversity and Conservation Biology
- Advanced Modeling of Watershed Dynamics

Interests

- Greatly passionate about conservation and restoration of California coastal ecosystems
- Spreading ecological awareness/encouraging others to participate in protecting natural environments
- Habitual rock climber, backpacker, surfer, and chess-enthusiast

Links:

<https://ccber.ucsb.edu/about/get-involved>

https://docs.google.com/forms/d/e/1FAIpQLSflyO0BnMWfm9_0ZiXanT5hFVJ_J3txCptChHd4-6muLwwwrww/viewform